# Ethical issues in Video games

By Francis Labelle

# Main concerns

- Videogame “addiction“
- Loot boxes and gambling
- Dark patterns
- Violence
- Representation

# Addictions

- Video game shutout for children in China and south korea(1 hour a day on friday+weekends and 06:00 to 24:00 for both countries respectivly)
- attention economy
- Due to their natures game can become quite addictive
- It is hard to differentiate passion and addiction.
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xxyRf3hfRXg

# Loot boxes and gambling

- All humans are prone to gambling addictions children more then others
- Loot boxes that cost money fall under many ethical issues and are mostly banned nowadays.
- There are some link between use of loot boxes and ingame gambling and gambling addictions in adults
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jh4UYz9apNk

# Dark patterns

- Deceptive design not in the users best interest
- Often used to either mislead or distract the user into making a decision they would not have made otherwise.
- Sometimes more obvious than others
- Guilt tripping
- Capitalizing on loss aversion
- Capitalizing on the fear of missing out (FoMO)
- Insidious pay to win
- Pay to remove friction
- Social obligation

# Violence

- Modern society is a lot more desensitized to violence nowadays
- No direct link with videogame playing and violent behaviour has been found
- Violent imagery can still disturb child and cause problems

# Examples of video games which may contain 1 or more of these Traits

- Fortnite
- WoW
- Overwatch
- Clash of Clans
- Call of Duty

# What can we do

- Ensure that when we copy successful games we do it in an ethical way
- Ensure that we keep a good balance between profit and UX(User experience)
- Keep tracks of statistics and update mechanics that are found to be harmful